

EDUCATION

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|---|---|
| Purdue University
▪ Ph.D. in Computer Science
◦ Advisor: Dr. Ruqi Zhang | IN, USA
<i>Aug. 2025 – 2030 (Expected)</i> |
| Tianjin University
▪ B.S. in Data Science and Big Data Technology, School of Mathematics
◦ Advisor: Dr. Bing Cao & Dr. Qinghua Hu | Tianjin, China
<i>Aug. 2021 – Jun. 2025</i> |

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on developing reliable and efficient post-training algorithms for foundation models, with an emphasis on improving the general intelligence and safety awareness of LLMs. I am particularly interested in how models can learn and self-evolve from limited, noisy, or imperfect supervision.

- **LLM/VLM Post-Training**
Reinforcement Learning, On-Policy Distillation, Reasoning, Self-Correction, and Self-Evolving
- **Alignment and Reliability**
Preference Alignment, Safety Alignment, Reliable Supervision, and Robustness

PUBLICATIONS

(* denotes equal contribution)

- [P1] **Does On-Policy Distillation Really Distill? From Noisy Teacher to Self-Improvement**
Yi Ding, Ruqi Zhang
Preprint  
- [P2] **Addressing Performance Saturation for LLM RL via Precise Entropy Curve Control**
Bolian Li, Yifan Wang, Yi Ding, Anamika Lochab, Ananth Grama, Ruqi Zhang
Preprint  
- [P3] **SafeWork-R1: Coevolving Safety and Intelligence under the AI-45° Law**
Shanghai AI Lab, ..., Yi Ding, [100+ Authors]
Technical Report 
- [C1] **Learning Self-Correction in Vision–Language Models via Rollout Augmentation**
Yi Ding, Ziliang Qiu, Bolian Li, Ruqi Zhang
International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026)  
- [C2] **Position: Modular Safety Guardrails Are Necessary for Foundation-Model-Enabled Robots in the Real World**
Joonkyung Kim, Wenxi Chen, Davood Soleymanzadeh, Yi Ding, Xiangbo Gao, Zhengzhong Tu, Ruqi Zhang, Fan Fei, Sushant Veer, Yiwei Lyu, Minghui Zheng, Yan Gu
International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026) 
- [C3] **Rethinking Bottlenecks in Safety Fine-Tuning of Vision Language Models**
Yi Ding*, Lijun Li*, Bing Cao, Jing Shao
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2026)  
- [C4] **Sherlock: Self-Correcting Reasoning in Vision-Language Models**
Yi Ding, Ruqi Zhang
Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)  
- [C5] **Visual Contextual Attack: Jailbreaking MLLMs with Image-Driven Context Injection**
Ziqi Miao*, Yi Ding*, Lijun Li, Jing Shao
Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing Main Conference (EMNLP 2025) 

[C6] **ETA: Evaluating Then Aligning Safety of Vision Language Models at Inference Time**

Yi Ding, Bolian li, Ruqi Zhang

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)  

[C7] **Test-Time Dynamic Image Fusion**

Bing Cao (Advisor), Yinan Xia*, Yi Ding*, Changqing Zhang, Qinghua Hu

Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2024) 

[C8] **Predictive Dynamic Fusion**

Bing Cao (Advisor), Yinan Xia*, Yi Ding*, Changqing Zhang, Qinghua Hu

International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2024) 

AWARDS

- **NSF ACCESS Discover Project Award** 2025-2026
- LLM Post-Training

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- **RZ-Lab, Purdue University** IN, USA
Research Assistant, Advised by Dr. Ruqi Zhang May 2024–May 2025
- **Open Trust Lab, Shanghai AI Laboratory** Beijing, China
Research Scientist, Advised by Dr. Lijun Li Dec. 2024–Mar. 2025
- **MLDM Lab, Tianjin University** Tianjin, China
Research Assistant, Advised by Dr. Bing Cao and Dr. Qinghua Hu Sep. 2023–Dec. 2024

SKILL

Languages: Chinese Mandarin (Native), English (TOEFL 102(22))

Research Abilities: Proficient in coding: Python, $\LaTeX$, MATLAB; Enjoys mathematical derivations; Solid foundation in mathematics and statistics.

SERVICE

- **Conference Reviewer**
- ICML 2026; NeurIPS 2025,2026; ICLR 2025,2026; ARR 2025 May